

First Game Set Friday At Cheshier

The University of Texas at El Paso's Miner baseball team will make their final home stand of the season Friday and Saturday, as they take on the defending NCAA champion and Western Athletic Conference co-leader, Arizona State at Cheshier Field.

Friday's game will begin at 2 p.m. with Saturday's double-header scheduled to get underway at 1 p.m. Cheshier Field is located just off Interstate 10 at the Ysleta cutoff.

Coach Andy Cohen's Miners are still in the thick of the race for the Southern Division title as they sport a 5-7 conference record, while Arizona State currently is tied for first with rival Arizona with a 7-5 record.

Last weekend the Miners completely surprised everyone by taking a three game series from New Mexico, dropping them from second place to the cellar.

Meanwhile, Arizona State was having its problems as they lost two of three games to Arizona. They were defeated 3-2 and 6-1 before coming from behind to win the final game 13-12.

Following last week's performance, Sun Devil coach Bobby Winkles has decided to shakeup his pitching rotation for the series with the Miners. Freshman Mike Hansen, owner of a 5-0 record and a 0.86 ERA, will start Friday's opener. As for Saturday's game, Winkles is still uncertain about his starters.

Cohen will counter on Friday with Marc Bombard, who is 7-4 on the season and who defeated the Sun Devils earlier in the season at Tempe, 11-1.

Saturday the Miners will go with Harry Milner (7-5), and Jim Greggerson (7-3). Milner struckout 13 Sun Devils in a 7-2 loss at Tempe.

Shortstop Lenny Randle has taken over the Sun Devils' batting leadership with a .329 mark, while Roger Schmuck is second at .324 and Gary Atwell, who got the winning hit against Arizona, is third at .323.

In the batting department the Miners are growing stronger with each game. With the re-entry of outfielder Albert Kimball, who was out for spring football practice, the Miners will have five starters batting over the 300 mark.

Bob Prokopowicz, who is currently fifth in the nation, is leading the team with a .451 average. He is followed by Rick Butler at .363, Juan Sandoval at .329, Kimball at .321 and Brian Harper at .312.

Pitchers Bombard at .357 and Milner at .400 will also add to the Miners' firepower.

As a team they now have a .300 batting average for the season, while Arizona State has a .262 average.

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